Final Stage Quick Reference

01 Summary vs. synthesis

Summary: Organize and accurately restate findings, proposals, agreements, and unresolved questions.
Synthesis: Connect viewpoints to develop a new insight or recommendation.
Remember: Summary captures what the group developed. Synthesis advances its thinking.

02 The synthesis framework

LISTEN for ideas and concerns. **CONNECT** viewpoints. **CREDIT** contributors. **ADVANCE** an insight, compromise, or recommendation.
Try: “Building on [name]'s idea and [name]'s concern…” · “If we combine those perspectives…” · “One way to address both concerns might be…”

03 Effective summaries

Organize by theme, not speaking order. Include barriers, important evidence and proposals, agreed recommendations, unresolved concerns, and credit for substantive contributions.
Try: “Our group identified three major considerations…” · “We agreed to recommend…” · “One concern that remains unresolved is…”

04 Consensus and task completion

Do not confuse majority support with unanimity. Identify remaining concerns, explore revisions, and confirm whether the revised outcome is supportable.
Check the **WHAT** (the problem) and **HOW** (required deliverable components). Does the final product meet the task? Can participants support it?
Try: “Does this revised proposal address the concerns raised?” · “Are we missing any required part of the task?” · “Can everyone support this recommendation?”

05 After the round

Gather belongings and leave promptly. Thank the judge briefly if appropriate. Do not request rankings or prolonged feedback. Consult your coach about unexpected procedural issues. Speak respectfully with fellow competitors afterward.